The Complete Catechism Kit

Illustrated Bible Stories

20 Great Stories From the Bible, Retold for Children



Bonus 2 · Free · Ages 6-10

A Note for Grown-Ups

A few words for parents, catechists, and teachers.

This booklet brings together twenty great stories from the Bible, from Creation to Pentecost. Each one is told in simple words for children ages 6-10, while staying faithful to the biblical text. The stories are retold in our own words; the verse to remember on each story's second page is quoted from the New American Bible, revised edition (NABRE), a Catholic translation widely used in the United States.

Each story takes up two pages: first the story and its illustration, then the page "What God Tells Us," with the message of the story, a verse to remember, three questions to talk about, and a short prayer.

A Few Tips

- Read the story aloud, or let your child read it if they can. Take time to look at the illustration together.
- Ask the questions without looking for the "right answer." The first two check understanding; the third invites your child to connect the story with their own life.
- The lines under the questions let older children write their answers; younger ones can simply talk about them.
- End with the short prayer, saying it together. You can make the Sign of the Cross at the beginning and at the end.
- One story a week is enough. You can follow the order of the booklet or choose a story that fits the liturgical season: the Annunciation during Advent and the Birth of Jesus at Christmas, the Passion and the Resurrection during Holy Week and Easter, Pentecost at the end of Easter Time.
- To go further, read the full passage in the Bible: the reference is under the title of each story.

Happy reading, and may the Word of God grow in your children's hearts!

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The Creation of the World

Based on the Book of Genesis, chapters 1-2

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



In the beginning, there was no sky, no sea, no flowers, and no animals. Only God existed, and he wanted to share his love.

On the first day, God spoke, and light appeared. God separated the light from the darkness: there was day, and there was night.

Then God made the sky, and he gathered the waters together so that dry land would appear. He made grass, flowers, and fruit trees grow. He placed the sun in the sky for the day, and the moon and the stars for the night.

Next, God filled the sea with fish and the sky with birds. He created all the animals of the earth: big ones and small ones, those that run and those that crawl.

On the sixth day, God created man and woman in his image. He blessed them and gave them all of his creation to take care of. God was happy with everything he had made: it was all very good!

On the seventh day, God rested. He blessed that day and made it holy. We too, on Sunday, the Lord's Day, take time to rest and to pray.

What God Tells Us

The Creation of the World · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Everything that exists comes from God: the sky, the earth, the animals... and you too! God made everything with love, and he created every person in his image. He gives us his creation so that we can take care of it.

A Verse to Remember

God looked at everything he had made, and found it very good. Evening came, and morning followed—the sixth day. **(Genesis 1:31)**

Let's Talk About It

1. What did God create on the first day?

2. What did God do on the seventh day?

3. What can you do to take care of God's creation?

†

My Little Prayer

Thank you, Lord, for the sun, the flowers, the animals, and all the people I love. Thank you for making me in your image. Help me take care of your creation. Amen.

Adam and Eve

Based on the Book of Genesis, chapters 2-3

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



The Lord God shaped the man from the dust of the ground and breathed life into him. This first man was named Adam. God placed him in a beautiful garden, the Garden of Eden, to work it and take care of it. Then God gave him a companion, Eve, and they were happy together.

In the garden there were all kinds of trees with delicious fruit. God told them they could eat the fruit of every tree except one: the tree of the knowledge of good and evil.

One day the serpent, the most cunning of all the animals, told Eve that they would not die if they ate that fruit. Eve looked at the fruit: it looked beautiful and delicious. She took some, ate it, and gave some to Adam, and he ate it too.

Right away they felt ashamed and went to hide among the trees. The Lord God called out to the man, "Where are you?" Adam and Eve had disobeyed, and they had to leave the garden.

But God did not abandon them. He made clothes for them and kept watching over them. And he promised that one day evil would be defeated. God kept that promise by sending us Jesus, our Savior.

What God Tells Us

Adam and Eve · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

God made us free, and he asks us to trust him. When we disobey, we move away from him. But God always loves us: he looks for us, and he forgives us when we come back to him.

A Verse to Remember

The LORD God then called to the man and asked him: Where are you? **(Genesis 3:9)**

Let's Talk About It

1. Which tree had God told them not to eat from?

2. What did Adam and Eve do after they ate the fruit?

3. When you have done something wrong, what can you do to make things right?

✝

My Little Prayer

Lord, sometimes I don't listen and I do what is wrong. Forgive me. Help me trust you and choose what is good. Thank you for always loving me. Amen.

Noah's Ark

Based on the Book of Genesis, chapters 6-9

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



A long, long time ago, people had forgotten God. They fought and hurt one another and the earth. But one man, Noah, was good and righteous: he loved God and listened to him.

God asked Noah to build a big wooden boat called an ark because a flood was coming. God told Noah to go inside with his wife, his three sons, and their wives. He also told him to bring a pair of every kind of animal. Noah did everything God had asked him to do.

When everyone was safe inside, the rain began to fall. It rained for forty days and forty nights! The water covered the whole earth, even the highest mountains. But the ark floated, and God watched over Noah and everyone who was with him.

One day the rain stopped. Little by little, the water went down, and the ark came to rest on the mountains of Ararat. Noah sent out a dove, and seven days later he sent it out again. Toward evening, the dove came back with a fresh olive leaf in its beak: the earth was drying out!

Noah, his family, and all the animals came out of the ark. Noah thanked God. Then God made a promise: never again would a flood destroy the earth. And he set his rainbow in the clouds as the sign of his promise to every living creature.

What God Tells Us

Noah's Ark · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Noah trusted God, even when he didn't understand everything. God protects those who listen to him, and he always keeps his promises. Every time you see a rainbow, remember that God loves you and will never leave you.

A Verse to Remember

"I set my bow in the clouds to serve as a sign of the covenant between me and the earth."
(Genesis 9:13)

Let's Talk About It

1. What did God ask Noah to build?

2. What was the dove carrying in its beak when it came back?

3. Can you remember a time when you trusted someone, even though it was hard?

†

My Little Prayer

Lord, like Noah, I want to listen to you and trust you. Thank you for watching over me and my family. Thank you for the rainbow that reminds me of your love. Amen.

Abraham, the Friend of God

Based on the Book of Genesis, chapters 12, 15, 17, and 21

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



Long ago there lived a man named Abram. One day the Lord asked him to leave his country, his family, and his father's house, and to go to a land that he would show him. God promised to bless him and to make him a great nation.

Abram didn't know where he was going, but he trusted God. He set out with his wife Sarai, his nephew Lot, his servants, and his flocks. He was already seventy-five years old!

Still, Abram and Sarai were sad: they had no children, and they were getting very old. One night, God led Abram outside his tent and told him to look up at the sky and count the stars, if he could. That was how many descendants he would have! Abram believed the Lord.

Later, God changed his name: Abram became Abraham, which means "father of many nations," and Sarai became Sarah.

The years went by, and God kept his promise: in their old age, Abraham and Sarah had a son. They named him Isaac, which means "he laughs," because their joy was so great!

Abraham is called our father in faith because he always trusted God.

What God Tells Us

Abraham, the Friend of God · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Abraham trusted God, even when his promises seemed impossible. God is faithful: he always does what he says, even if we have to wait. Like Abraham, we can believe in him with all our heart.

A Verse to Remember

Abram put his faith in the LORD, who attributed it to him as an act of righteousness.
(Genesis 15:6)

Let's Talk About It

1. What did God ask Abram to count in the sky?

2. What was the name of Abraham and Sarah's son?

3. When is it hard to trust God?

†

My Little Prayer

Lord, like Abraham, I want to trust you, even when the road is long or hard. I know you keep your promises. Keep me close to you. Amen.

Joseph and His Brothers

Based on the Book of Genesis, chapters 37-45

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



Jacob had twelve sons, but he loved Joseph more than all the others. He had a beautiful, colorful coat made for him. Joseph's brothers became so jealous that they could no longer speak kindly to him.

One day, out in the fields, they tore off his coat and threw him into an empty well. Then they sold him to traders who were on their way to Egypt. They made their father believe that a wild animal had eaten him.

In Egypt, Joseph went through very hard times, but God was with him. God gave him the gift of explaining dreams. Joseph explained Pharaoh's dreams: seven years of plenty were coming, then seven years with no food. So Pharaoh made Joseph governor over all of Egypt, and Joseph had great stores of grain set aside.

When the famine came, Joseph's brothers traveled to Egypt to buy food. They did not recognize him! Joseph could have taken revenge. Instead, he wept and said, "I am Joseph, your brother! Don't be afraid. God brought me to Egypt before you, to save many people." He comforted them and hugged them.

Joseph forgave his brothers, and the whole family, with old Jacob, came to live near him.

What God Tells Us

Joseph and His Brothers · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Joseph could have stayed angry with his brothers, but he chose to forgive. God can turn even hard times into something good. To forgive is to love the way God loves.

A Verse to Remember

"But now do not be distressed, and do not be angry with yourselves for having sold me here. It was really for the sake of saving lives that God sent me here ahead of you." **(Genesis 45:5)**

Let's Talk About It

1. Why were Joseph's brothers jealous?

2. What did Joseph do when his brothers came to Egypt?

3. Is there someone you need to forgive?

✝

My Little Prayer

Lord, when someone hurts me, help me forgive like Joseph. Take jealousy and anger out of my heart. Fill me with your love. Amen.

Moses and the Burning Bush

Based on the Book of Exodus, chapter 3

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



The people of Israel lived in Egypt, where they had become slaves. Pharaoh made them work very hard, and the Israelites cried out to God.

Moses was a shepherd in the desert. One day he led his flock to Horeb, the mountain of God. There he saw something amazing: a bush that was on fire but did not burn up!

Moses came closer to get a better look. Then God called from the middle of the bush, "Moses! Moses!" Moses answered, "Here I am." God told him to take off his sandals, because he was standing on holy ground. Moses covered his face, because he was afraid to look at God.

God told him that he had seen how his people were suffering and had heard their cries. He wanted to set them free and lead them to a good land, flowing with milk and honey. And he was sending Moses to Pharaoh!

Moses was afraid. "Who am I to go to Pharaoh?" he asked. God answered, "Don’t worry. I will always be with you."

So Moses set out. With God’s help, he was going to set his people free.

What God Tells Us

Moses and the Burning Bush · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

God sees those who suffer and hears their cries. He called Moses by name, and he calls us too. When we are afraid, he tells us that he is with us.

A Verse to Remember

When the LORD saw that he had turned aside to look, God called out to him from the bush: Moses! Moses! He answered, "Here I am." **(Exodus 3:4)**

Let's Talk About It

1. What was so amazing about the bush Moses saw?

2. What did God ask Moses to take off?

3. How can you say "Here I am!" to God in your life?

My Little Prayer

Lord, you know my name and you call me. Like Moses, I want to tell you: here I am! When I am afraid, remind me that you are with me. Amen.

Crossing the Red Sea

Based on the Book of Exodus, chapters 13-15

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



After God had sent many signs, Pharaoh finally let the people of Israel go. Led by Moses, the people left Egypt. The Lord went ahead of them: by day in a column of cloud, by night in a column of fire.

But Pharaoh changed his mind. He sent his chariots and soldiers after the Israelites. They reached the edge of the sea: in front of them, water; behind them, the Egyptian army! They were very frightened.

Moses told the people, "Don't be afraid! Stand firm, and today you will see the Lord save you!"

Moses stretched out his hand over the sea. All night long the Lord made a strong wind blow, and the waters were split in two. The Israelites walked through the middle of the sea on dry ground, with a wall of water on their right and on their left.

When the Egyptians tried to follow them, the waters came back and covered the chariots. The people of Israel were saved! They put their trust in the Lord. With Moses and his sister Miriam, all the people sang and danced to thank God.

What God Tells Us

Crossing the Red Sea · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

When everything seemed lost, God opened a way. He never lets down those who count on him. In our troubles, we can trust him: he is our Savior.

A Verse to Remember

"The LORD will fight for you; you have only to keep still." **(Exodus 14:14)**

Let's Talk About It

1. Who was chasing the people of Israel?

2. How did God open a path through the sea?

3. When you are afraid, what can you say to God?

My Little Prayer

Lord, when I am afraid or can't see a way out, open a path for me. I trust you, because you are my Savior. Thank you for protecting me. Amen.

David and Goliath

Based on the First Book of Samuel, chapter 17

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



The people of Israel were at war with the Philistines. The two armies faced each other on opposite sides of a valley. Every day, a Philistine giant named Goliath stepped out of the ranks. He wore a bronze helmet and armor and carried a huge spear. He mocked the army of Israel and the living God. All the soldiers were afraid of him.

A young shepherd named David came to bring food to his brothers in the army. When he heard Goliath, he told King Saul that he would fight him. The king said that David was only a boy. But David insisted, "The Lord saved me from the lion and the bear. He will save me from this Philistine too!"

David took off the king's armor, which was too heavy for him. He took his staff, chose five smooth stones from the stream, and went forward with his sling in his hand.

Goliath laughed at him. David answered, "I come to you in the name of the Lord!" He put a stone in his sling and let it fly... and the stone struck the giant on the forehead. Goliath fell face down on the ground!

David had no sword: his strength was his trust in God. Later, this young shepherd became a great king of Israel.

What God Tells Us

David and Goliath · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

David was small, but he was strong because he trusted God. It is not size or strength that matters, but faith. With God, we can face the "giants" in our lives: fear, sadness, or hard times.

A Verse to Remember

"The same LORD who delivered me from the claws of the lion and the bear will deliver me from the hand of this Philistine." **(1 Samuel 17:37)**

Let's Talk About It

1. What did David take with him to face Goliath?

2. Where did David's courage come from?

3. What "giant" scares you, and how can God help you?

My Little Prayer

Lord, when my problems seem big, give me David's courage. I know you are with me. With you, I am not afraid. Amen.

Daniel in the Lions' Den

Based on the Book of Daniel, chapter 6

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



Daniel lived in Babylon, far from his homeland. He was wise and honest, and King Darius wanted to put him in charge of the whole kingdom. The other officials became jealous. They looked for a way to bring him down, but Daniel never did anything wrong.

So they convinced the king to sign a law: for thirty days, no one could pray to any god or any person except the king. Anyone who disobeyed would be thrown into the lions' den!

Daniel heard about the law, but he kept praying to the true God three times a day, kneeling at his open window that faced Jerusalem, just as he always had.

His enemies saw him praying and told the king. The king was very sad, but he had to have Daniel thrown into the lions' den. All night long, the king could neither eat nor sleep.

At dawn, he hurried to the den and called out to Daniel. Daniel answered, "God sent his angel, and he shut the lions' mouths! They did not hurt me." Full of joy, the king had Daniel lifted out of the den: he didn't have a single scratch! Then the king ordered everyone in his kingdom to respect Daniel's God.

What God Tells Us

Daniel in the Lions' Den · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Daniel kept praying, even when it was dangerous. He knew that God was stronger than anything. Prayer keeps us close to God, and God protects those who stay faithful to him.

A Verse to Remember

This gave the king great joy. At his order Daniel was brought up from the den; he was found to be unharmed because he trusted in his God. **(Daniel 6:24)**

Let's Talk About It

1. How many times a day did Daniel pray?

2. Who shut the lions' mouths?

3. What time of day do you like to pray?

†

My Little Prayer

Lord, like Daniel, I want to pray to you every day, at home, at school, and everywhere. Give me the courage to stay faithful. May your angel watch over me. Amen.

Jonah and the Big Fish

Based on the Book of Jonah, chapters 1-3

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



The Lord spoke to Jonah. He told him to go to Nineveh, the great city, and warn its people that their wickedness had come before him. But Jonah did not want to go. He got on a ship sailing the other way, far away from the Lord.

Out at sea, the Lord sent a strong wind. A great storm came up, and the ship was about to break apart. The sailors were terrified. Jonah admitted that it was his fault and told them to throw him into the sea. As soon as they did, the sea became calm.

Then the Lord sent a big fish to swallow Jonah. For three days and three nights, Jonah stayed in the belly of the fish. There he prayed to the Lord with all his heart. Then the Lord spoke to the fish, and it spit Jonah out onto dry land.

This time Jonah obeyed: he went to Nineveh and announced God's message. Right away, the people of Nineveh believed God. Everyone, from the greatest to the least, was sorry for the wrong they had done and changed their ways.

And God, full of mercy, forgave them.

What God Tells Us

Jonah and the Big Fish · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Jonah tried to run away from God, but God didn't give up on him. God always gives us another chance. He loves all people, and he is happy to forgive those who change their ways.

A Verse to Remember

When God saw by their actions how they turned from their evil way, he repented of the evil he had threatened to do to them; he did not carry it out. **(Jonah 3:10)**

Let's Talk About It

1. Where had God asked Jonah to go?

2. What did Jonah do in the belly of the big fish?

3. How do you feel when someone forgives you?

†

My Little Prayer

Lord, sometimes I don't feel like doing what you ask. Thank you for always giving me another chance. Teach me to obey you and to forgive others too. Amen.

The Annunciation

Based on the Gospel According to Luke, chapter 1

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



In a small town in Galilee called Nazareth lived a young woman named Mary. She was engaged to Joseph, a man from the family of King David.

One day God sent the angel Gabriel to Mary. The angel said to her, "Hail, full of grace! The Lord is with you!" Mary was deeply troubled: what could this greeting mean?

The angel told her, "Don't be afraid, Mary! God is very pleased with you. You will have a son, and you will name him Jesus. He will be called Son of the Most High, and his kingdom will never end."

Mary asked, "How can this happen?" The angel explained, "The Holy Spirit will come upon you. The child will be holy, and he will be called Son of God. Your relative Elizabeth, even in her old age, is also expecting a son. Nothing is impossible for God!"

Then Mary answered, "I am the servant of the Lord. Let everything happen to me as you have said." And the angel left her.

By her "yes," Mary welcomed Jesus, the Son of God, who came to live among us.

What God Tells Us

The Annunciation · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Mary said "yes" to God with trust and generosity. Thanks to her "yes," Jesus came into the world. We too can say "yes" to God every day by listening to him and loving others.

A Verse to Remember

Mary said, "Behold, I am the handmaid of the Lord. May it be done to me according to your word." Then the angel departed from her. **(Luke 1:38)**

Let's Talk About It

1. Which angel did God send to Mary?

   _____

2. What did Mary answer the angel?

   _____

3. How can you say "yes" to God today?

   _____

†

My Little Prayer

Mary, my Mother, you said "yes" to God. Teach me to listen to him and trust him the way you did. Always lead me to your Son Jesus. Amen.

The Birth of Jesus

Based on the Gospel According to Luke, chapter 2

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



The Roman emperor wanted to count all the people in his empire. Everyone had to go and register in the town of their ancestors. So Joseph went up from Nazareth to Bethlehem, the city of David, with Mary, who was expecting her baby.

While they were there, the time came for the baby to be born. Mary gave birth to her firstborn son. She wrapped him in swaddling clothes and placed him in a manger, since there was no other place for them to stay.

In the fields nearby, shepherds were spending the night watching over their flocks. Suddenly an angel of the Lord appeared to them, and God's glory lit up the night all around them. They were very frightened. But the angel said, "Don't be afraid! I bring you good news, a great joy for all the people: the Savior is born!"

Then a whole crowd of angels began to praise God and sing, "Glory to God in heaven, and peace on earth!"

The shepherds hurried to Bethlehem. They found Mary, Joseph, and the newborn baby lying in the manger. Jesus, the Son of God, had been born among us!

What God Tells Us

The Birth of Jesus · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

At Christmas, God gives us the most wonderful gift: his Son Jesus. He was born poor and small, in a manger, to be close to everyone. The shepherds welcomed him with joy: we too can open our hearts to him.

A Verse to Remember

"For today in the city of David a savior has been born for you who is Messiah and Lord."
(Luke 2:11)

Let's Talk About It

1. In which town was Jesus born?

2. Who heard the good news from the angel?

3. How can you get your heart ready to welcome Jesus?

†

My Little Prayer

Baby Jesus, thank you for coming to earth for us. I open my heart to you: come and live in it. With the angels, I sing: "Glory to God!" Amen.

The Boy Jesus in the Temple

Based on the Gospel According to Luke, chapter 2, verses 41-52

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



Every year, Mary and Joseph went to Jerusalem for the feast of Passover. When Jesus was twelve years old, he went with them, as was the custom.

When the feast was over, Mary and Joseph started back home to Nazareth. They thought Jesus was walking with the other travelers. But that evening they looked for him among their relatives and friends: Jesus wasn't there! Very worried, they went back to Jerusalem.

After three days, they finally found him in the Temple. He was sitting among the teachers, listening to them and asking them questions. Everyone was amazed at his understanding and his answers.

His mother said, "Son, why did you do this? Your father and I were so worried, looking everywhere for you!" Jesus answered that he had to be in his Father's house. They did not understand what he meant.

Jesus went back down to Nazareth with them, and he obeyed them. Mary kept all these things in her heart.

What God Tells Us

The Boy Jesus in the Temple · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Jesus knew that God was his Father, and he loved being in his Father's house. He also loved Mary and Joseph and obeyed them. Like Jesus, we can feel at home with God, at church and in prayer, and grow every day in wisdom and love.

A Verse to Remember

"Why were you looking for me? Did you not know that I must be in my Father's house?"
(Luke 2:49)

Let's Talk About It

1. How old was Jesus when he stayed behind in the Temple?

2. Where did Mary and Joseph find Jesus?

3. What do you like to do when you go to church?

†

My Little Prayer

Lord Jesus, you loved to be in your Father's house. Help me love to pray and to go to church, and help me obey my parents, as you did. Amen.

The Baptism of Jesus

Based on the Gospel According to Matthew, chapter 3

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



John the Baptist lived in the desert. He wore clothing made of camel's hair and called the people to change their lives, because the Savior was coming. Many people came to him, and he baptized them in the Jordan River.

One day Jesus came from Galilee to the Jordan to be baptized by John. John tried to stop him. "You should be the one baptizing me," he said, "not the other way around!" But Jesus insisted, and John baptized him.

As soon as Jesus was baptized, he came up out of the water. Then the heavens opened: Jesus saw the Spirit of God coming down like a dove and resting on him. And a voice from heaven said, "This is my beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased."

That day, God showed who Jesus was: his beloved Son. The Father was speaking, the Son had just come up out of the water, and the Holy Spirit was coming down like a dove: this is the Holy Trinity!

Soon after, Jesus began his mission: to announce God's love to everyone.

What God Tells Us

The Baptism of Jesus · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

At Jesus' baptism, God the Father said that Jesus is his beloved Son. Through our Baptism, we too became children of God. Baptism is the first of the sacraments: it welcomes us into the great family of the Church.

A Verse to Remember

And a voice came from the heavens, saying, "This is my beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased." **(Matthew 3:17)**

Let's Talk About It

1. In which river was Jesus baptized?

2. In what form did the Spirit of God come down on Jesus?

3. Do you know where and when you were baptized?

†

My Little Prayer

Thank you, Lord, for my Baptism: I am your beloved child. May your Holy Spirit always live in my heart. In the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Spirit. Amen.

The Wedding at Cana

Based on the Gospel According to John, chapter 2

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



There was a wedding in Cana, in Galilee. Mary, the mother of Jesus, was there. Jesus had been invited too, along with his disciples. It was a big celebration!

But during the feast, the wine ran out. The bride and groom were going to be very embarrassed! Mary noticed and told Jesus, "They have run out of wine!" Then she said to the servants, "Do whatever Jesus tells you."

Six large stone jars stood nearby, each one big enough to hold many gallons. Jesus told the servants, "Fill these jars with water." They filled them to the brim. Then he said, "Now draw some out and take it to the man in charge of the feast."

The man in charge tasted it: the water had become wine! He didn't know where this wine had come from, but the servants knew. He called the bridegroom and praised him for saving the best wine until the end.

This was the first of Jesus' signs. He revealed his glory, and his disciples believed in him.

What God Tells Us

The Wedding at Cana · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Mary noticed what the bride and groom were missing and told Jesus about it. She does the same for us: she brings our needs to her Son. And she gives us great advice: do whatever Jesus tells us.

A Verse to Remember

His mother said to the servers, "Do whatever he tells you." **(John 2:5)**

Let's Talk About It

1. What ran out during the wedding feast?

2. What did Jesus change the water in the jars into?

3. What can you do to obey Jesus and love others?

†

My Little Prayer

Mary, our Mother, you see what we need. Bring our prayers to Jesus. Help me do whatever he tells me. Amen.

Jesus Feeds the Five Thousand

Based on the Gospel According to John, chapter 6

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



Jesus was by the Sea of Galilee. A large crowd was following him, because people had seen him heal the sick. Jesus went up the mountain and sat down with his disciples.

He looked up and saw the huge crowd coming toward him. He asked Philip where they could buy enough bread to feed them all. Philip answered that even a great deal of money could not buy enough bread for everyone to have a little.

Andrew, another disciple, told Jesus that a boy there had five barley loaves and two fish, but that it was nothing for so many people.

Jesus told the disciples to have the people sit down. There was plenty of grass there. About five thousand men sat down. Then Jesus took the loaves, gave thanks to God, and handed them out. He did the same with the fish. Everyone ate as much as they wanted!

Afterward, Jesus asked his disciples to gather the leftover pieces so that nothing would be wasted. They filled twelve baskets! The people were amazed by the sign Jesus had done.

What God Tells Us

Jesus Feeds the Five Thousand · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

The boy gave the little he had, and Jesus turned it into a great miracle. When we share, even a little, Jesus can do great things. At Mass, Jesus feeds us himself: he gives himself to us in the Eucharist.

A Verse to Remember

"There is a boy here who has five barley loaves and two fish; but what good are these for so many?" **(John 6:9)**

Let's Talk About It

1. How many loaves and fish did the boy have?

2. How many baskets did they fill with the leftover pieces?

3. What could you share with others this week?

✝

My Little Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank you for our daily bread. Teach me to share what I have with those who need it. Prepare my heart to receive you in the Eucharist. Amen.

Jesus Calms the Storm

Based on the Gospel According to Mark, chapter 4

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



One evening, after teaching the crowd all day long, Jesus told his disciples, "Let's go across the lake." They got into the boat and set out.

Jesus was tired. He lay down in the back of the boat, rested his head on a cushion, and fell asleep.

Suddenly a violent storm blew up. The waves crashed over the boat, and it began to fill with water. The disciples were terrified. They woke Jesus up and asked, "Teacher, don't you care that we are going to drown?"

Jesus got up. He gave an order to the wind and told the sea to be still. At once the wind stopped, and everything became perfectly calm.

Then Jesus asked his disciples, "Why are you so afraid? Don't you have faith yet?"

The disciples were full of wonder. They asked one another, "Who is this? Even the wind and the sea obey him!" They were beginning to understand that Jesus was not like anyone else: he was the Son of God.

What God Tells Us

Jesus Calms the Storm · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Even when Jesus seems to be asleep, he is there, with us in the boat. The storms of life, like fear, sadness, or arguments, are not stronger than he is. When we call on him, he brings peace back to our hearts.

A Verse to Remember

He woke up, rebuked the wind, and said to the sea, "Quiet! Be still!" The wind ceased and there was great calm. **(Mark 4:39)**

Let's Talk About It

1. What was Jesus doing when the storm began?

2. What did Jesus say to the wind and the sea?

3. What "storm" would you like to give to Jesus?

†

My Little Prayer

Jesus, when I am afraid, I call on you like your disciples did. Calm the storm in my heart and give me your peace. Increase my faith. Amen.

The Good Samaritan

Based on the Gospel According to Luke, chapter 10

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



One day a scholar of the law asked Jesus what he had to do to have eternal life. Jesus asked him what was written in the Law, and the man answered, "Love God with all your heart, and love your neighbor as yourself." Then the man asked who his neighbor was. So Jesus told this story.

A man was going down from Jerusalem to Jericho. On the way, robbers attacked him. They took everything he had, beat him, and left him half dead by the side of the road.

A priest happened to come by. He saw the injured man... and passed by on the other side. Then a Levite, who served in the Temple, came along. He saw him too, and passed by on the other side.

Finally a Samaritan came by. Samaritans and Jews did not get along. Yet when he saw the man, he was moved with compassion. He went over and treated his wounds with oil and wine. Then he put him on his own animal, took him to an inn, and cared for him. The next day, he gave money to the innkeeper so that he would keep taking care of the man.

Jesus asked which of the three had been a neighbor to the injured man. The scholar answered that it was the one who had shown him mercy. Jesus told him to go and do the same.

What God Tells Us

The Good Samaritan · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Our neighbor is anyone who needs us, even if we don't know them or they are different from us. Jesus asks us not to pass by on the other side, but to stop and help, with a heart full of compassion.

A Verse to Remember

He said in reply, "You shall love the Lord, your God, with all your heart, with all your being, with all your strength, and with all your mind, and your neighbor as yourself." **(Luke 10:27)**

Let's Talk About It

1. Which two men passed by without stopping?

2. What did the Samaritan do to help the injured man?

3. Who could you help this week, at home or at school?

✝

My Little Prayer

Lord Jesus, open my eyes to see those who need help. Give me a good heart like the Samaritan's. Teach me to love my neighbor as myself. Amen.

The Passion and the Resurrection

Based on the Gospel According to Matthew, chapters 26-28, and the Gospel According to John, chapter 19

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



Jesus had spent his life doing good, healing the sick, and announcing God's love. But some leaders refused to believe in him, and they decided to have him put to death.

On Thursday evening, Jesus shared the Last Supper with his apostles. He gave them the bread and the wine, which became his Body and Blood: it was the first Eucharist. Then he was arrested on the Mount of Olives.

On Friday, Jesus was condemned to death. He was made to carry his cross to Golgotha, and he was crucified. Near the cross stood Mary, his mother, with the disciple whom Jesus loved. Jesus forgave those who were hurting him. Then he said, "It is finished." And he died, giving his life out of love for us. His body was laid in a tomb cut out of the rock and closed with a large stone.

On Sunday, at dawn, Mary Magdalene and the other Mary went to the tomb. The angel of the Lord, dressed in clothes as white as snow, had rolled away the stone. He told them that Jesus was not there: he had risen, just as he had said.

Full of joy, they ran to tell the disciples. Jesus is alive! Alleluia!

What God Tells Us

The Passion and the Resurrection · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

Jesus gave his life on the cross because he loves us. But death did not have the last word: on the third day, he rose from the dead! That is the great feast of Easter. Jesus is alive, and he stays with us forever.

A Verse to Remember

"He is not here, for he has been raised just as he said. Come and see the place where he lay." **(Matthew 28:6)**

Let's Talk About It

1. What happened on Easter morning?

2. Who told the women that Jesus had risen?

3. How can you thank Jesus for his love?

†

My Little Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank you for giving your life for me. You are risen, you are alive! Fill my heart with your joy, so that I can share it with everyone. Alleluia! Amen.

Pentecost

Based on the Acts of the Apostles, chapters 1-2

Read this story with a grown-up. Then take a good look at the picture.



After his Resurrection, Jesus appeared to his disciples several times. Then he went up to heaven, to be with his Father. Before he left, he promised to send them the Holy Spirit.

The apostles stayed together in Jerusalem. They prayed with one heart, together with Mary, the mother of Jesus.

On the day of Pentecost, they were all gathered in the same house. Suddenly a sound came from the sky, like a strong rushing wind, and it filled the whole house. Something like flames of fire appeared and came to rest on each of them. The Holy Spirit filled them all, and they started speaking languages they had never learned.

In Jerusalem there were people from many countries. When they heard the noise, they came running. Each one heard the apostles speaking in their own language! They were amazed.

Then Peter, filled with courage, stood up and announced to everyone that Jesus had risen. That day, about three thousand people were baptized.

Pentecost is the birthday of the Church!

What God Tells Us

Pentecost · Read, think, and talk about it with a grown-up.

Name: _____

The Message of the Story

The Holy Spirit filled the apostles with courage to tell the whole world about Jesus. We too receive the Holy Spirit in Baptism and Confirmation. He helps us to love, to pray, and to talk about Jesus with joy.

A Verse to Remember

And they were all filled with the holy Spirit and began to speak in different tongues, as the Spirit enabled them to proclaim. **(Acts 2:4)**

Let's Talk About It

1. What came to rest on each of the apostles?

2. How many people were baptized that day?

3. When do you need the Holy Spirit's help?

†

My Little Prayer

Come, Holy Spirit, fill my heart. Give me your strength and your joy, so that I can love Jesus and help others know him. Amen.